

Casting Connections: A Fishy Approach to Conference Engagement

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Figure 1: All the Fun Interactions through Sketches and Humour (FISH).

ABSTRACT

Early-career researchers often feel like small fish in a big pond, surrounded by towering giants of knowledge. However, considering this apparent drawback overlooks a potential opportunity for networking and collaboration. To facilitate engagement in a way where ideas can swim freely, I present FISH which is “fun interactions through sketches and humour”. Drawing inspiration from the metaphor of fishing, this form of interaction allows attendees (at conferences) to cast their intellectual nets, hook meaningful networks, and navigate the currents of collaboration. Embark on this academic angling adventure with me, where engagement isn’t just

a catchphrase; it’s the bait that hooks us into the vibrant, collaborative learning ecosystem, making every conference a reel success.

CCS CONCEPTS

• **Human-centered computing** → **Interaction design theory, concepts and paradigms.**

KEYWORDS

Fun, Interaction, Sketches, Humour

ACM Reference Format:

Joseph Tu. 2024. Casting Connections: A Fishy Approach to Conference Engagement. In *Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '24)*, May 11–16, 2024, Honolulu, HI, USA. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 1 page. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3613905.3649126>

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

Together, we’re “surfing the world”, one creative fisher-person at a time. A heartfelt shoutout to the participants (n=85) who creatively dived into drawing fish at the CHI Play 2023 conference, making a real splash with this innovative idea.

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CHI EA '24, May 11–16, 2024, Honolulu, HI, USA
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ACM ISBN 979-8-4007-0331-7/24/05
<https://doi.org/10.1145/3613905.3649126>